

Smell and taste

The senses of smell and taste allow you to experience a whole range of aromas and flavors. They work as close partners. Smell sensors in your nose detect odors in the air you breathe while taste sensors in your mouth pick out tastes in the food you eat.

NOSE AND MOUTH

There are millions of special cells at the top of the nasal cavity inside your nose that can detect different scents. In your mouth, your tongue contains thousands of taste buds that recognize different tastes. Nerves (yellow) carry signals from these receptor cells to the brain to be analyzed.

◀ SENSING SMELL

In your nose there are millions of smell receptors like this one (blue). Tiny hairlike structures on the receptors detect more than 20,000 different smells.



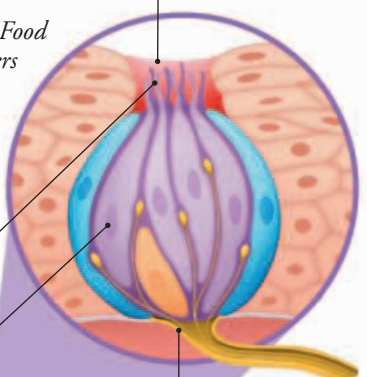
▶ **TASTE BUD** Food dissolved in saliva enters through a hole at the top of the taste bud and is tasted by tiny hairs.

Taste hairs detect tastes

Receptor cell sends signals

Taste hole (pore) in papilla

Nerve fiber carries signals to the brain



◀ **TINY BUMPS** Your tongue is covered with pimplelike bumps called papillae. Pointy ones help the tongue grip food during chewing. Round ones contain taste buds.

